hours, the consensus emerged that there was no way to redress asymmetry in military capability except to have the same capability in specific areas as your potential opponent. The scientists vowed to achieve a reduced CEP in the accuracy of Prithvi's delivery, perfecting the Ka band guidance system for Trishul and realising al carbon-carbon re-entry control surfaces for Agni by the end of the year. The vow was later fulfil ed. The year also saw tubelaunched Nag flights, and the manoeuvre of Trishul at seven metres above sea level, at speeds which exceeded three times the speed of sound. The latter was a breakthrough in the development of an indigenous ship-launched anti-sea-skimmer missile.

The same year, I received an honorary degree of Doctor of Science from the I T, Bombay. In the citation read by Prof. B Nag on the occasion, I was described as "an inspiration behind the creation of a solid technological base from which India's future aerospace programmes can be launched to meet the chal enges of the twenty-first century". Wel , perhaps Prof. Nag was only being polite, but I do believe that India wil enter the next century with its own satel ite in geo-stationary orbit 36,000 km away in space, positioned by its own launch vehicle. India wil also become